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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Wednesday, February 4, 2026

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[00:27:40] chamber the senate will come to order the senators will please take their

[00:29:54] seats those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery the senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able and we will be led in prayer today by the reverend - Dr. Schoonmaker of Second Baptist Church from Richmond, Virginia.

[00:30:15] And following the prayer, everyone will please remain standing and be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Neela Saravanakumar of Prince William. - Let us pray.

[00:30:34] We are grateful, O God, for the goodness of creation and for the countless gifts you shower upon us. I thank you for our minds. Infuse them with a wisdom that transcends ordinary thinking and considers the plight of the overlooked. Thank you for our hearts.

[00:30:51] Fill them with a love that surpasses common affection and extends to every neighbor with authentic compassion. Thank you for our hands. Animate them with an ethic that exceeds typical charity and establishes justice and righteousness in society.

[00:31:08] Thank you for our voices. Amplify them with a sincerity that eclipses conventional chatter and conveys what is true, edifying, and noble. Give us understanding amid distinct perspectives and goodwill amid diverse personalities that all within our commonwealth might flourish together in peace.

[00:31:32] Amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:32:06] Clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye. The clerk will close the roll.

[00:32:31] You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Tuesday, February 3rd, 2026. The senator from Orange moves that the reading of the journal be waived. all in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 35 noes 5. ayes 35 noes 5 the reading of the journal is waived the

[00:33:05] clerk will report any communication from the house of delegates the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Good afternoon, Madam President. Good afternoon. Madam President, I move to waive the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates. The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[00:33:32] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 33, noes 7. Ayes 33, noes 7. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor. We do not have any Madam President. We've now arrived

at the time in the morning hour when we have the honor of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us today in our Senate gallery. And I share my daily reminder about our procedure. We

[00:34:07] will have a senator rise and provide an introduction for their visitors and I will then offer the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to complete the Senate's welcome. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, today the invocation was given by someone who is not a stranger to us, the Reverend Dr. Noel Schumacher from Second Baptist Church, if he doesn't mind standing. He's served as the senior pastor at Second Baptist Church since 2019, a native of South Carolina. He was ordained in North

[00:34:47] Carolina and he's been a pastor in Tennessee. He holds way too many degrees. He's way smarter than all of us. And he's also been published in the Religion News Service and Baptist News Global. He loves spending time with his wife, Danya, and his two daughters, Maggie Nora, and it's good to see him here again and so I hope we give them a warm Senate welcome. I thank the senator for that welcome and Reverend Schoonmacher thank you so much for the invocation that you shared with us today thank you for the prayers that you offered to all of us in the in the Senate chamber and to our Commonwealth. Senators I ask that

[00:35:25] we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Reverend Dr. Schoonmacher. The chair recognizes the senator from Hampton. Thank you madam president I stand for two introductions. The senator has the floor. Thank You Madam President. Joining us today in the gallery are members of the Virginia Midwives Association Alliance and this group makes normal births in all settings available to birthing people their babies and families and if you would give them the

[00:36:03] kind welcome of the Senate. I thank the senator for that introduction and welcome to the Virginia Midwives. Thank you for the work that you do. It is such essential healthcare, the services that you provide. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Virginia midwives. Senator. Thank you.

[00:36:32] Secondly, joining us in the gallery, the Virginia Community Action Partnership is the statewide association representing the Commonwealth's 31 Community Action Agencies. I am grateful for the amazing Community Action Agencies serving my district and many in the region, the Hampton Roads Community Action Program. I I want to thank Ms. Edith White, CEO of HRCAP, and Mr. Kevin Ote, HRCAP COO, who is board chair of the Virginia Community Action Partnership, the state association led by CEO Eric Johnston, for their team colleagues being with us in the gallery and across Capitol Square today.

[00:37:07] Please extend to them the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and welcome to the Hampton Roads Community Action Program. you for your representation on behalf of so many different communities in the Hampton Roads area. Thank you for speaking to our legislators today as you share your priorities. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Hampton Roads Community Action Program. The chair recognizes the

[00:37:40] senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purposes of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you. Today in the gallery we have representatives from the fairfax county democratic committee 50 plus caucus we have two representatives irv varcone and bob watts uh the fairfax county democratic committee 50 plus caucus does outstanding work supporting our state legislators and community leaders

[00:38:19] helping to build awareness and support for legislation that is relevant to adults who are 50 and over, not only in Fairfax County, but in all of Virginia. I wanna thank these two individuals and their entire caucus for their endless advocacy and all the work they do to uplift the issues of importance to this population and the ways that we can support them.

[00:38:48] And with that, I hope you join me in giving them a warm welcome. I thank the senator for that introduction, and welcome to the 50-plus caucus of the Fairfax County Democratic Committee. Your advocacy and work is certainly important to me as someone who is a member of that 50-plus caucus.

[00:39:06] So thank you for speaking on behalf of so many throughout Virginia on the issues that impact all of us. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the 50-plus caucus representatives of the Fairfax County Democratic Committee.

[00:39:23] The chair recognizes the senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for purposes of an introduction.

[00:39:40] The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. With us in the gallery today are advocates from the Children's Advocacy Centers of Virginia and also from our local Children's Advocacy Centers. The CACs are part of Virginia's law enforcement effort when it comes to gathering evidence and data when young children are sexually abused or physically abused and prosecutors need to hold the offenders accountable.

[00:40:16] So the Children Advocacy Centers actually conduct trauma-informed interviews of these very young victims. They are very much a part of the team that tries to bring justice and healing to our most vulnerable. And I will just say that the CACs also provide resources and follow-up services to our young victims, connecting them with ongoing mental health services and other treatment programs. I hope it is the will of the senate to warmly welcome our

[00:40:53] children advocacy centers. Thank you. I thank the senator for that introduction and welcome to the representatives from the children's advocacy centers. Thank you for this most essential work that you do to bring healing to individuals, to young children in particular that have suffered and experience severe trauma your work is absolutely essential so we are grateful for for all that you do through the cac's senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate

[00:41:22] to the representatives of the children's advocacy centers the chair recognizes the senator from charlottesville madam president i rise for two introductions senator has the floor first to monitor to introduce christina evans and tish blackwell from the jefferson area board on aging Jabba alongside over 200 advocates from across the Commonwealth of Virginia who are here today as part of older Virginians advocacy day their collective presence highlights our shared commitment to elevating the needs of

[00:42:02] older Virginians and ensuring they have the support and resources needed to age with dignity and independence their dedication is a testament to the impact of Virginia's AG network and I'm proud to welcome you here today I ask that you give them the warm greetings to the Senate. I thank the senator for that introduction and thank you for joining us today. Thank you for the advocacy that you are offering on behalf of so many of our aging communities and the representation that you bring. Thank you Miss Blackwell for joining us. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Jabba Tish Blackwell.

[00:42:41] Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President I don't have too many notes on this group but it's another group from Charlottesville from VA APCO NENA 9/11 dispatch a group from Charlottesville I'd ask that you give them the warm greetings of the Senate if you will please stand well thank you to all of you who have joined us it's a large coalition the Virginia APCO NENA 9/11

[00:43:16] dispatch thank you for the work that you do to protect our communities to be voices in issues and moments of urgency and trauma and I hope you are having good conversations with your legislators throughout the day today as you visit us in the capital. Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to representatives from Virginia APCO NENA 9/11 dispatch. The chair recognizes a

[00:43:55] senior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you madam president I rise for an an introduction. Senator has the floor. Madam President, today I have the pleasure of introducing the Virginia Space Authority who are visiting the Capitol in connection with the Virginia Aerospace Day. With them is CEO, Executive Director, Major General Ted Mercer. Located on Virginia's beautiful eastern shore, Virginia Spaceport Authority operates one of only four public spaceports in the United States, making it truly unique to the Commonwealth and a national

[00:44:32] level asset. The Space Force plays a critical role in advancing aerospace initiatives, national security and economic development, while positioning Virginia as a leader in the rapidly growing commercial space industry. 2026 will be a banner year for the Authority with eight planned space launches, the most ever in a single year, and approximately 30 launches planned over the next three years. All you have an open, all of you have an open invitation to attend any of these launches.

[00:45:02] Madam President, I ask the members of the Senate to join me in welcoming the Virginia Spaceport Authority and join them at Aerospace and Aviation Reception this evening at 5:30 at the Main Street Station. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction and welcome to the Virginia Spaceport Authority.

[00:45:21] Thank you for your leadership in this very essential industry that is so critical and so much a part of Virginia's landscape. you for the work you do and the reception that you're going to be holding this evening. We look forward to seeing you. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Virginia Spaceport Authority representatives. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President.

[00:45:58] I rise for an introduction. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. In the gallery today are representatives of the Culmore Clinic in Falls Church, which serves as a critical healthcare access point for underserved populations in Fairfax County, providing primary care, prescription medications, behavioral health services and medical specialists at no cost to local residents who face barriers to traditional healthcare systems. With a network of more than 130 medical professionals and support staff, Culmore Clinic helps vulnerable neighbors remain healthy and avoid missed time from work due to illness, ultimately reducing unnecessary visits to the emergency room. Culmore Clinic is

[00:46:36] just one in a statewide network of 70 free and charitable clinics that serve as efficient and high-quality medical homes constituency constituents and essentially safety net of care for Virginia's underserved and madam president I wish that you would give them the warm welcome of the Senate thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the representatives from the Culmore Clinic. Thank you for the essential work that you do to provide healthcare services for so many in our community who need access and need the

[00:47:14] kind of services that you are providing. It's even more critical now than ever before, so thank you so much for the the work that you are doing. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the Culmore Clinic. The chair recognizes a senior senator from Loudoun. Good morning Madam President, members of the body. I rise today to recognize- The senator has the floor. Thank you Madam President. I rise today to recognize and welcome

[00:47:50] cancer survivors, caregivers, and advocates here in Richmond for Cancer Action Day with the American Cancer Society Cancer Action Network. I can't see them. Oh, stand up! ACS CAN is the nonprofit, nonpartisan advocacy arm of the American Cancer Society and they work to advance evidence-based policies that prevent cancer, improve treatment, and save lives. More than 50,000 Virginians will be diagnosed with cancer this year and as we all know, cancer

[00:48:27] doesn't choose us based on political party, geography, or our backgrounds. Like many in the body, my family has been personally touched by this disease and that's why I'm especially grateful for the more than 50 advocates who have come here today to share their stories, show their faces, and remind us about the stories behind the bills that we vote on. Madam President, please join me in welcoming them and recognizing them. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction and welcome to the representatives of the Cancer Action Network. Thank you for your advocacy on behalf of so many individuals and on

[00:49:00] so many families and we know that cancer is a is a serious concern that affects every family and your advocacy is absolutely essential thank you for the work that you are doing senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the cancer action network advocates the chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico thank you madam president Madam President, I advise for two introductions.

[00:49:39] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President and members of the Senate, joining us today in the gallery are a group of nuclear engineering students, and I ask them to please stand. These students are joining us from several universities across the Commonwealth, including VCU, the University of Virginia, Virginia Tech, and Liberty University, and are here as a part of their annual American Nuclear Society Student Lobby Day.

[00:50:10] The students are here with Ms. April Wade, the executive director of the Virginia Nuclear Energy Consortium. And Madam President, I ask that you grant them the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction.

[00:50:25] And welcome to our students representing the American Nuclear Society program. The work you're doing, I know, is innovative, requiring a lot of entrepreneurial and creative talent. So thank you for your engagement in such a critical area.

[00:50:45] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our students who are representing the American Nuclear Society. Senior Senator from Henrico.

[00:51:00] - Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, the next group joining us in the gallery is a little bit more seasoned than those folks. Today is our Older Virginia Advocacy Day here at the Capitol. And so we have some older folk here.

[00:51:18] The purpose of today's, if I can ask them to stand, I thought everybody that was older was gonna stand. The purpose of today's activities is to unite older adults, advocates, and state legislators to engage in meaningful discussions and support efforts that enable aging at home and in the community.

[00:51:43] Area agencies on aging from around the state, including the SPAN Center here in Richmond, are coming together to amplify the voices of older adults and caregivers to ensure every Virginian can age with dignity and choice.

[00:52:02] And Madam President, I ask that you grant them the warm welcome of the Senate. - Thank you, Senator, for the introduction, and thank you to our representatives from the Spann Center. Thank you for the work that you do on advocating on behalf of so many in our communities who are aging and the need that we have to address so many concerns for our aging population.

[00:52:25] We look forward to your visits to our legislators and the advocacy work that you're gonna be doing throughout the day today. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome the Senate to the representatives of the span center the chair recognizes the senator from Lynchburg thank you madam president I rise for the purposes of an introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president and members of the Senate today joining us in the gallery we have members of the Virginia

[00:53:01] Association of Defense attorneys members of the VADA are here today meeting with members of the courts committee to share their perspective and expertise on legislation we are considering during this session and this year and mainly to weigh in against bills being carried by the senator from Eastern Fairfax the VADA attorneys are engaged in civil defense and are committed to the professional zealous and ethical representation of their

[00:53:35] clients in Virginia courts. This evening the VADA will be holding its second annual legislative reception. It's not snowing today so it'll be a lot easier to get to than last year's. Please check your calendars for the location of that. I hope you will please join me in giving the members of the Virginia Association of Defense Attorneys the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you Senator for the introduction and welcome to the Virginia Association of Defense Attorneys. Thank you for the advocacy and the work that you are doing on behalf of so many Virginians, and I hope you're

[00:54:11] having productive conversations with every office, including the senator from Eastern Fairfax's office. And senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of the Virginia Association of Defense Attorneys. The chair recognizes the senator from Tazwell.

[00:54:39] Thank you, Madam President. I rise for purpose of an introduction. senator has the floor today madam president we have radford university's advocacy day and we have a if they could stand in the gallery we have a special group of students visiting the capital and joining us here in the gallery i have the honor of representing radford university go highlanders which is a public university in southwest virginia that was founded by the general Virginia General Assembly in 19 and 10. Currently enrolls over 7,800 students.

[00:55:16] Radford University is one of our most accessible and affordable public institutions in the Commonwealth. 92 percent of Radford undergraduates are Virginians and 31 percent are first-generation college students. The Radford University students who are here with us today come from all regions of of the Commonwealth, and they shared their stories with many of you this morning.

[00:55:44] Madam President, if you would join, or if you would give them a warm welcome of the Senate, I would appreciate that. - Thank you, Senator, for the introduction of our representatives from Radford University. I had the pleasure and the honor of meeting with many of our student representatives yesterday, and I hope you've had very engaging conversations as you have spent the past couple of days

with us on the Capitol, and thank you for the stories that you are sharing about the impact that education at Radford is having on your personal lives.

[00:56:17] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives from Radford University. The chair recognizes the senator from York.

[00:56:37] - Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction. - Senator has the floor. - I am honored to introduce advocates from the Peninsula Agency on Aging, along with more than 200 other advocates from across the state of Virginia who are here today as part of Older Virginians' Advocacy Day.

[00:56:57] Their collective presence highlights our shared commitment to elevating the needs of older Virginians and ensuring that they have support and resources needed to age with dignity and independence. Peninsula Agency on Aging is the Area Agency on Aging for the Virginia Peninsula serving older adults and family caregivers across Newport News, Hampton, Williamsburg, Pocosin, James City County, and York County. For 52 years they have been a trusted resource for older Virginians, helping people stay in their homes, remain connected to their communities, and maintain dignity and

[00:57:36] and independence as they age. Through nutrition, transportation, in-home supports and care coordination, the agency meets people where they are, often at moments of real need, and help ensure that aging in Virginia is just not about living longer, but living well. Their dedication is a testament to the impact of Virginia's aging network, and I am proud to welcome them here today. Please give them the warm welcome of the senate thank you senator for that introduction and thank you for

[00:58:10] the represent representation that you are providing uh through the peninsula agency on aging again uh as we've seen from many of our advocacy groups who are here today uh speaking on behalf of our aging virginians is so critical and necessary and i like what the senator said it's not just a matter of how we age how long we live but how well we're able to live out our final years so thank you for the work that you are doing and the advocacy that you are providing on behalf of so many

[00:58:47] senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate to the representatives of the peninsula agency on aging the chair recognizes the senior senator from loudon thank you madam president Madam President, I rise for the purposes of an introduction.

[00:59:08] Senator has the floor. Madam President, today we are pleased to welcome in the gallery Supervisor Julie Brissman, who serves as the Supervisor for Loudoun County's Algonquian District. There she is. Supervisor Brissman is the Chair of Loudoun County's Finance and Government Operations Committee and serves on the Virginia's Association of Counties Board of Directors, as well as VACO's Finance and Election Steering Committee.

[00:59:33] She was first elected in 2020 and re-elected in 2023. In addition to our public service, Supervisor Briskman is a mother of two children who attended Loudoun County Public Schools and are now pursuing college and graduate studies. And she is also a five-time marathon finisher, something we all should aspire to, Madam President.

[00:59:52] Madam President, I ask the Senate to join me in welcoming Supervisor Briskman to the Virginia Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And welcome to Supervisor Julie Briskman. Thank you for joining us. You've been no stranger to our Senate chamber. we're delighted to see you again and thank you for the work that you do on behalf of so many in the district and the county that you represent senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of

[01:00:17] the senate to supervisor julie briskman do we have any additional representatives from the children's advocacy centers thank you is there any other business to come in the morning hour the clerk

[01:00:51] will call the calendar senate calendar for wednesday february 4th 2026 uncontested calendar senate bills on third reading the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax madam president i move that all the senate bills on third reading uncontested counter on pages one through five senate bills 14 through senate bill 686 be placed on their final passage in the block any senator's iron move bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the the bill. The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested calendar, third reading, pages

[01:01:27] one through five, Senate Bill 14 through Senate Bill 686, be placed upon their final passage in the block, with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. All in favor of that motion will say aye.

[01:01:44] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The bills are before us in the block. The clerk will read the number of the bills. Senate Bill 14, Senate Bill 214, Senate Bill 221, Senate Bill 455, Senate Bill 485, Senate Bill 513, Senate Bill 514, Senate Bill 532, Senate Bill 550.

[01:02:17] Senator from, the junior senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President. I ask that the Senate Bill 550 on page 5 of the printed calendar be removed from the block. Without objection, Senate Bill 550 on page 5 will be out of the block.

[01:02:35] Thank you, Madam President. I move to reconsider the board. Senator, we will come back to the bill in a few minutes. Senate Bill 573, Senate Bill 686. the question is shall the bills in the block pass that is all bills except for Senate bill 550 on page five all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close

[01:03:12] the roll I was 40 no zero eyes 40 no zero the bills in the block pass returning to Senate bill 550. The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudon. Thank you madam president. I move to reconsider the vote by which Senate bill 550 was engrossed and advanced to its third reading. The question is, shall the vote by which Senate bill 550 was engrossed and advanced to his third reading be reconsidered? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those

[01:03:47] opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no zero. Ayes 40, no zero. The bill is reconsidered. Madam President, I move that the reading of the floor amendment be waived.

[01:04:12] The question is, shall the reading of the floor amendment be waived? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The reading of the floor amendment is waived. Junior Senator from Loudoun. Madam President, I move that the floor amendment be agreed to.

[01:04:32] I'm speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The floor amendment makes a minor change towards the end of the bill, striking the provision that would require a transportation network company to notify a driver of any updates of their trip receipts.

[01:04:49] This positions the bill so that all stakeholders have peace in the valley, and we can avoid having it sent back to us. I renew my motion that the floor amendment be agreed to. The question is, shall the floor amendment be agreed to?

[01:05:07] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The floor amendment is agreed to. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed. advance to its third reading the question is shall Senate bill 550 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the bill is engrossed and advanced senator madam president I move that we dispense with a third constitutional reading of Senate

[01:05:44] bill 550 the question is shall we now suspend the rules and dispense with a third constitutional reading of Senate Bill 550. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no zero. Ayes 40, no zero. The motion passes. Senator. Madam President, I move that the bill passed and speaking to the bill.

[01:06:20] senator has the floor thank you madam president this is my legislation related to the transparency of gig drivers for gig drivers the bill reported out of committee unanimously and as i said moments ago with the floor amendment we have peace in the valley with all stakeholders i renew my motion that the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 550 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any

[01:06:53] senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero senate bill 550 passes thank you madam regular calendar senate bills on third reading senate bill 350 a bill relating to elections absentee voting processing and counting ballots prior to the close of polls.

[01:07:23] The chair recognizes the senator from Western Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. So SB 350, this does a few things. Number one, make sure that we get election results a lot quicker on election day itself.

[01:07:39] Number two, allows the folks over at the Registrar's office to get home a little bit earlier. And three, I like to think it preserves a little bit more trust in the system because people aren't waiting until 11 12 o'clock at night to find out you know what the results were so the heart of the bill as amended yesterday i'll draw y'all's attention to the lines 96 through 99 and actually actually we'll go to 101. uh so 96 says in the case of absentee ballots that are counted by ballot scanner machine the officers of election may begin to ascertain and record the number of votes cast by absentee ballots anytime after 5 p.m on the day of the election in accordance with the

[01:08:18] procedures prescribed by the Department of Elections including procedures to preserve ballot secrecy. No vote totals shall be transmitted outside of the central absentee voter precinct until after the closing of polls. So this is that balance that we wanted making sure that election observers can still be there but at the same time they can't they're gonna be able to leak out stuff that's gonna change the outcome of an election because we're starting this process less than two hours before polls close. So with that Madam President I renew my motion to pass the bill the chair recognizes a senator from Roanoke

[01:08:53] thank you madam president I want to thank the senator from Western Prince William for this legislation over the last four or five months there's been a lot of conversation about it and the amendments that she brought yesterday were the consequence of a lot of conversations with folks in the campaign world on the Republican side of the aisle the concern on our side is often you don't want numbers getting out beforehand I think these amendments made it so that is not likely to happen I appreciate that and the the greater

[01:09:32] concern of the bill itself like the senator said is one that I've worked on a lot in the last few years is there's some bad actors that try to use delays and election results to foster fear in the process. It's not good for anyone that believes in representative government and I appreciate her effort to help fix this situation. Thank You Madam President. The question is, shall Senate Bill 350 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye,

[01:10:07] those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 17.

[01:10:26] Ayes 23, noes 17. Senate Bill 350 passes. Senate Bill 493, a bill relating to consumer protection, automatic renewal or continuous service offers, disclosure and cancellation.

[01:10:47] The chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the bill pass in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. So SB 493, the click to cancel bill, ensures that consumers can easily cancel services they have previously purchased by creating a streamlined and understandable cancellation process.

[01:11:11] It requires companies that offer subscriptions and auto renewals to provide simple mechanisms so it is as easy to cancel as it is to sign up. And this really is about transparency and ensuring that consumers are protected, and if they need to cancel a subscription or auto renewal, they can do that very easily.

[01:11:39] We had good support in a committee, and I appreciate that, and we did have a few concerns that were brought up that we addressed in the floor amendment yesterday. So I think with all of those having been taken care of, I hope it will be the will of the body to support the bill.

[01:12:02] Thank you. The question is, shall Senate Bill 493 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[01:12:18] Have all the senators voted? Does any senator wish to change their votes? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0.

[01:12:34] Senator from Stafford, Senator from Stafford, did you wish to speak? The chair recognizes the Senator from Roanoke.

[01:12:50] Thank you, Madam President. My apologies. We'll pause for a second. Senate Bill 17, relating to enforcement, vehicle liens, property value.

[01:13:06] Now the Senator from Roanoke. Thank you, Madam President. I'd like to make a motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the Senate pass Senate Bill 17. And speaking of that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:13:23] Senate Bill 17 is legislation that everyone that's been here for a minute has seen previously. What this deals with when there are discarded vehicles, the process at which they may not have to go through court to be disposed of by the tow companies.

[01:13:48] Every few years we need to increase the value because otherwise if we do not increase the dollar value, it will continue clogging up the courts. And it is now time to make that change again. It will be a pleasure of the Senate to pass the bill.

[01:14:07] The question is, shall Senate Bill 17 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:14:25] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 32, noes 8. Ayes 32, noes 8, Senate Bill 17 passes. Senate Bill 135, a bill relating to the Department of Motor Vehicles, Motor Vehicle Title Databases.

[01:14:42] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Virginia Beach. Madam President, I'd like to take Senate Bill 135 by for the day, so one of my friends can get clarification on an issue with the database. And while we're at it, I'd like to also take by Senate Bill 595, which is the other part to this.

[01:15:02] We will come back to that motion when we reach Senate bill 595, but without objection Senate bill 135 goes by for the day Senate bill 218 a bill to direct the director of the Department of Corrections To pause placements in at Red Onion State Prison the chair recognizes the senator from Richmond City Madam President I move the bill pass Speaking to the bill.

[01:15:34] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 218 places a temporary pause on approving the placement of out-of-state inmates at Red Onion Prison under the Interstate Corrections Compact. The bill directs the compact administrator of Virginia State Council of Interstate Adult Offender Supervision and the director of the Department of Corrections to continue accepting and reviewing applications but prohibits final approval of any placements at Red Onion until the General Assembly explicitly reauthorizes.

[01:16:02] SB 218 does not withdraw Virginia from the compact, rather it restores legislative oversight. Madam President, I move that the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 218 pass?

[01:16:18] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:16:35] Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, Nose 19, Senate Bill 218 passes. Senate Bill 396, a bill relating to driver's license requirements for initial licensure persons age 18 to 21.

[01:16:51] The chair recognizes the senator from York. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill passes. Speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. What this bill does is requires drivers who are over 18 and less than 21 who have never held a license to complete a state approved driver education program and hold a learner's permit for at least 90 days. The law as it stands now is a either/or. You could do either of these and obtain a license and it's now been

[01:17:29] increased from 60 days of learner permit from 60 days to 90 days and this is being done because those drivers in that 18 to 19 year old range are the the least experienced and they have the highest rating of crashes of any group of drivers and I ask that the bill be passed so we can make Virginia a safer place to to drive the question is shall Senate bill 396 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

[01:18:07] to vote. Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 19, Noes 21.

[01:18:24] Ayes 19, Noes 21. The bill does not pass. Senate Bill 426. Senator from Lynchburg. Having vote on the side by which that bill failed to pass, I'd ask that we reconsider.

[01:18:44] The question is, shall we reconsider the vote by which senate bill 396 did not pass all in favor of that motion is this recorded all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 40 no zero eyes 40 no zero the bill the motion is reconsidered the bill is back in front of us

[01:19:24] Madam President, could that bill go by temporarily? Without objection, Senate Bill 396 goes by temporarily. Senate Bill 426, a bill relating to alteration of suspension system and bumper heights proof of compliance.

[01:19:43] The chair recognizes the senator from Mecklenburg. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill passed in speaking to that. Senator has the floor. This bill refers to the Carolina squat, which is a type of vehicle that is tall in the front and low in the back. And we passed a bill in 2022 before I was here outlawing this type of vehicle.

[01:20:11] But what we have come to find is there's no incentive for anyone to fix this. They just go to court when they get a citation and they get a slap on the hand and a fine. But this bill would give the judge the option to, if before they come to court, they fix the vehicle and they lower the front, that they could possibly waive the fee. And that gives them an incentive to go ahead and fix that vehicle so it's no longer out of compliance with the law. And so I move that

[01:20:44] the bill pass. The question is, shall Senate Bill 426 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, noes 3. Ayes 37, noes 3. Senate Bill 426 passes. Senate Bill 446, a bill relating to limited

[01:21:21] duration licenses, driver privilege cards, and permits, and identification privilege cards expiration the chair recognizes a senior senator from Prince William thank you madam president move that the bill pass and speaking to the motion senator has the floor thank you very much this bill is familiar to the body this extends the limited driver privilege cards to the same exact duration that you currently get which is eight years streamlines and helps the DMV both both lines and also those who have duration of stay many times if it's

[01:22:01] 18 months, going back multiple times, creates lines in the DMV. This has nothing to do with anything other than ensuring that those who have the skill sets to drive on our roads also continue to have insurance and the same credentialing that we all do. So I ask the bill to pass.

[01:22:21] The question is, shall Senate Bill 446 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll.

[01:22:37] Ayes 21, noes 19. Ayes 21, noes 19. Senate Bill 446 passes. Senate Bill 506, a bill relating to vehicle equipment, films on windshields. The chair recognizes the Senator from Prince Edward. Thank you Madam President. I move passage of the bill and speak to the motion. Senator has the floor. So this bill just updates some language of Virginia code that was originally intended to prevent the tinting of windshields but there are some new films that protect your windshields help keep them cleaner reduce UV exposure for

[01:23:13] people sensitive to UV and this would just update the code to to make room for this new technology there is a standard that was a committee amendment that would would that would align this with clarity standards that are that are used for windshields in general the question is shall Senate bill 506 pass All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no.

[01:23:38] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 1. Ayes 39, noes 1.

[01:23:54] Senate Bill 506 passes. Senate Bill 583. A bill relating to parking, stopping, and standing enforcement, bus obstruction, monitoring systems, civil penalties.

[01:24:10] The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill pass and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Senate Bill 583 is a critical bill that will improve access safety, reliability for bus transit riders in Virginia, especially for seniors and disabled Virginians.

[01:24:32] This legislation allows localities to authorize the use of bus obstruction monitoring system to enforce local ordinances related to parking stoppage and standing in bus stop zones or lanes reserved for buses or other specified vehicle.

[01:24:48] This technology does not respond to moving violation. The system only transmits photos when onboarding system detects that the bus lane is blocked. When a vehicle is blocking a bus stop, it creates a danger to disable and senior riders as well as families with small children.

[01:25:07] When the bus is blocked from getting to the curb or loading passengers properly, riders are forced to walk into an active traffic lane to board or exit the bus. Also because street parking is lower than the bus stop sidewalk, it is very difficult for a disabled rider.

[01:25:27] In addition to the safety concern, clearing illegal parking from bus stops and bus lanes produces faster, more reliable bus services, increasing ridership and reducing congestion for everyone. WMATA operates the clear lane program in DC and soon to be in Maryland in its third year of operation it has significantly benefited for bus transit riders in DC.

[01:25:50] Bus lane violations have decreased 41 percent and bus stop violations have decreased 27 percent. Clear lane routes have had 10 percent increase in wheelchair ramp deployment, meaning more disabled riders were able to access buses. with that madam president i move that the bill pass and present senator from king george would the senator yield for a question will the senator yield i yield for a question senator from king george um thank you madam president i was trying to read this section really fast and as i see it

[01:26:28] from lines 28 through 30 it talks about giving someone a ticket if they are standing in a bus top zone or lanes reserved for transit buses or other specific vehicles so if i understand this bill correctly if you go to one of the local grocery stores oftentimes there's a lane and it's marked off and it says you know reserved for emergency vehicles or fire vehicles and oftentimes Sometimes you see where someone will pull off to let a family member run into the grocery

[01:27:08] store and then they'll go park. Or sometimes they'll even wait if they just have to run in and grab a bottle of water or something. If I understand this bill, we now would be able to adopt an ordinance and take photo evidence of that and charge that person with a civil violation.

[01:27:33] Am I reading that correctly? Senator from Central Fairfax. Madam president to the gentleman to an extent that is incorrect it would only be if it's related to the bus lane there are a lot of bus lanes where they will have side spots that are related to parking enforcement parking for Walmart purposes they'll have their vehicles that could park on the sides and a lot of times individuals may block those so this is only if it's if there's a bus that is moving that has this technology installed and it is

[01:28:08] obstructing that path then it will be uh there will be a enforcement mechanism senator from king george would the gentleman here for another question will the gentleman yield yield for another question senator has the floor i would ask the senator what does the language mean or other specific vehicles when such images contain evidence of a violation of such ordinance that is found on uh at the end of line 28 and beginning on 29 it doesn't say anything

[01:28:43] about bus it says other vehicles senator from central fairfax uh madam president and to the The gentleman, it is my understanding that is related to if there are other vehicles, again, that are owned or operated by some of these transit agencies that get to use some of those side sort of spots, that's what this is related to.

[01:29:10] Senator from King George. I thank the Senator, Madam President. That gives me a great deal of pause because I think under this bill you could effectively adopt an ordinance where you could have cameras and you could issue somebody a civil violation, and I don't know how much the fine would be, but I'm sure it would be $100 simply for pulling up in front of the grocery store and dropping somebody off to go in.

[01:29:40] And I understand what the gentleman's trying to do to help the bus, the transit agencies, but I think the bill's actually a lot broader than that. Senator from Central Fairfax. Madam President, again, I ask that this bill pass.

[01:30:00] Again bus obstruction monitoring system is defined in the bill to ensure that it is only the lanes where the buses are and nothing beyond that. The question is, shall Senate Bill 583 pass?

[01:30:18] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:30:33] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 18, noes 21. Ayes 18, noes 21. Senate Bill 583 does not pass. bill 595 a bill related to mechanics and storage liens vehicle data reported from the committee on transportation and there is a floor substitute the chair recognizes a senior senator from Virginia Beach madam president connect go by for the day thank you without objection Senate bill 595 goes by for the day Senate bill 663 a bill relating to emergency vehicles exempt from

[01:31:13] certain traffic regulations. The chair recognizes the senator from York. Thank you madam president I move that the bill passed and speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you. This bill provides that non-emergency law enforcement exemptions to speed limits when done to establish evidence of other violations of law and when using emergency lights and sirens may pose a a safety risk. Currently, law enforcement can only exceed speed limits in non-emergency

[01:31:46] situations only to test the accuracy of speeding, measuring devices such as radar or speedometers, or for following another vehicle for the purpose of speeding. This bill also provides that non-emergency law enforcement exemptions to parking or stopping while having due regard for safety. So let me give you a couple examples of this. One would be where you are responding to a bank robbery and

you do not want to alert robbers who may all be on scene by using a siren additionally let's say that a law enforcement officer sees a

[01:32:24] car that has either been reported stolen or reported to be have used in another crime and you're trying to catch up doing the speed limit but you get caught at a stoplight and that car continues on you then want to be able to exceed the speed limit to catch up to either identify if the car is actually involved or not or see who the occupants are so this is something that is routinely done it's just not legal and the intent of this is to make standard law enforcement operations that are currently being done to make those legal because they want to do things in a proper manner so I ask that the bill be

[01:33:04] passed. Madam President. Senator from King George. Will the gentleman yield for a question? Will the gentleman from York yield? How you, Madam President. Senator from King George has the floor. Madam President, I'd ask the senator, I mean, and the whole purpose of using lights and sirens so that citizens don't get run over when people are speeding down the road? Senator from York?

[01:33:33] Madam President. Yeah, that's correct. So what I'm saying is you may not be going 80 or 90 miles an hour but if you're in a 45 zone you may have to go something like 60 miles an hour to catch up uh and you not necessarily want to alert that uh vehicle that is in front of you so that they get a chance of of evading in fact it's it's to stop high speed chases and such in some circumstances um i i thank the senator madam president this is another bill that gives me a lot of concern i mean if you're trying to stop a murder, I get it, but otherwise you can eventually catch up to

[01:34:13] the perpetrator without risking the lives of the citizens. I'm sorry, but I think this does more harm than good. Senator from York. I renew my motion. The question is, shall Senate Bill 663 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any

[01:34:45] senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the roll 16 knows 24 i 16 knows 24 senate bill 663 does not pass returning to page 9 senate bill 396 the senator from york the senator from york i'm sorry madam president i was we we've returned to page 9 on the calendar

[01:35:24] Senate Bill 396. I move that the bill pass as previously explained. The question is, shall Senate Bill 396 pass?

[01:35:42] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:35:58] Ayes 22, noes 18. Ayes 22, noes 18, Senate Bill 396 passes.

[01:36:14] Uncontested calendar, Senate Bill is on second reading. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Henrico. Yes, Madam President. Madam President, I'm sorry. I haven't voted on the prevailing side in which SB 583 failed. I wish that we could reconsider that vote.

[01:36:34] 583 on page 11. Yes, ma'am. The question is, shall the vote by which Senate Bill 583 did not pass be reconsidered?

[01:36:50] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no, zero.

[01:37:08] Ayes 40, no, zero. The motion to reconsider passes. chair recognizes the senator from central fairfax madam president could that bill go by for the day without objection senate bill 583 goes by for the day uncontested calendar senate bills on second reading the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax uh thank you madam president i move that all the senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages 12 through

[01:37:47] on page 12. senate bill 480 through 806 be advanced their engrossment and third reading in the block at the adoption of the amendment there to any senator desiring a move bill from the block please do so if the clerk has read the number of the bill the question is shall the senate bills on the second reading on the uncontested calendar on page 12 senate bill 480 through senate bill 806 be engrossed in advance to their third reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments there too that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill all in favor of

[01:38:23] that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will read the number of the bills. Senate Bill 480 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. Senate Bill 744 reported from the Committee on Local Government.

[01:38:41] Senate Bill 806 reported from the Committee on Local Government. The question is, shall the Senate bills now be engrossed in advance to their third reading? all in favor of that motion will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the bills are engrossed in advance to their third reading regular calendar senate bills on second reading senate bill 74 relating to affordable housing local zoning ordinance authority reported from the committee on local government with amendments the chair recognizes the senior senator from fair from

[01:39:20] Prince William. Thank you Madam President. I move the amendments be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee on Local Government be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments from the Committee on Local Government are agreed to. Senate Bill 328. Senior Senator from Prince William. Madam President, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third read. The question is, shall Senate bill 74 now be engrossed in advance to his third reading all in favor of the motion will say aye

[01:39:58] any opposed no the ayes have it the bill is engrossed and advanced senate bill 328 a bill relating to housing for local employees grants for home ownership reported from the committee on local government the chair recognizes the senior senator from loudon madame president i move that bill be engrossed in advance to his third constitutional reading the question is shall Will Senate Bill 328 be engrossed in advance to its third reading?

[01:40:26] All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 346, a bill relating to zoning manufactured housing, reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute.

[01:40:45] The Chair recognizes the Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Local Government be agreed to? All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:41:01] The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 346

now be engrossed and advanced to its third reading? All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Any opposed, no.

[01:41:18] The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 388, a bill relating to affordable housing, religious organizations, and other non-profit tax-exempt properties. Reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute.

[01:41:36] The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill go by for the day for additional amendment. Without objection, Senate Bill 388 goes by for the day. Senate Bill 454, a bill relating to zoning by right multifamily developments, reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute.

[01:42:02] The chair recognizes the senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the committee substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Local Government be agreed to? All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Any opposed, no.

[01:42:17] The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the bill be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 454 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye.

[01:42:35] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 717, a bill relating to transit-oriented housing overlay districts report, Reported from the Committee on Local Government with amendments.

[01:42:53] The chair recognizes the senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee amendments to be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee on Local Government be agreed to? All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye.

[01:43:08] Aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 717 now be engrossed and advanced to a third reading?

[01:43:23] All in favor of that motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 776, a bill relating to reporting fines, cost restitution for damages, support, or community services from probation or failure to pay, reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments.

[01:43:51] The chair recognizes the senator from Mecklenburg. Thank you, Madam President. I move the committee amendments. The question is, shall the amendments from the committee for courts of justice be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no.

[01:44:07] The ayes have it. The amendments are agreed to. Senator from Mecklenburg. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 776 now be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bill is engrossed and advanced.

[01:44:28] Uncontested calendar, Senate bills on first reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the Senate bills on first reading on the uncontested and

regular calendars, pages 16 through 31, Senate bills 10 through 763, that the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with.

[01:44:46] The question is, shall the rules be suspended in the first constitutional reading of the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars, pages 16 through 31, Senate Bill 10 through Senate Bill 763 be dispensed with.

[01:45:02] All in favor of the motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[01:45:18] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no 0. Ayes 40, no 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Henrico. Not yet.

[01:45:34] Eastern Fairfax. One of these days. Thank you, Madam President. I move that all those bills go by for the day. The question is, shall the Senate bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on their second reading be passed by for the day? All in favor of the motion will say aye.

[01:45:50] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills will go by for the day. Uncontested calendar, Senate joint resolution on third reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[01:46:07] Good to be home. Madam President, I move that the Senate joint resolution on third reading, uncontested calendar on pages 32 through 32, SJR 12 through 59, be placed in your final passage on the block. Any senator desired to move a bill from the block, please do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution.

[01:46:26] The question is, shall the Senate joint resolutions on the uncontested calendar, third reading on page 32 Senate joint resolution 12 through SJR 59 be placed upon their final passage in the block with the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The resolutions are now before us in the block, the clerk will read the number of the resolution. Senate Joint Resolution 12,

[01:47:06] Senate Joint Resolution 56, Senate Joint Resolution 59. The question is, shall the resolutions in the block be agreed to? All in favor of agreeing to the resolutions will say aye. Any opposed no.

[01:47:23] The ayes have it. The resolutions in the block are agreed to. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry the clerk does that complete today's calendar? Yes, sir. We will return briefly to the morning hour The senior senator from loudon Thank you madam president. Madam president. I rise for the purposes of an introduction The senator has the floor madam president in the gallery with us Today are two individuals who are my constituents

[01:48:02] Rachel Nestor and Craig Gill. They both want to stand up and I think they're here Doing lobby work in part for Pfizer today. Is that is that right? Yes, but also Rachel Nestor happens to be the mother of one of our Senate pages Who happens to be on the floor today and is turning a bright shade of red?

[01:48:24] Off to my right hand side behind us and so Madam President, we are always thrilled whenever Individuals entrust us with their children and to have them down here I know the members of the Senate know just how valuable these pages are to us and how much they help us throughout the session and how dependent we are on them and so a special thank you to my constituents for coming down and a special

thank you to Madison for the work that she does for us every day. Madam President I hope you will and members of the General Assembly will the Senate will join me in welcoming

[01:49:01] Rachel and Craig to to the gallery and thanking Madison for her work. I thank the senator for that introduction and welcome to Rachel and Craig Thank you for joining us in the Senate gallery. Thank you, especially Rachel for letting us have Madison with us in the in the General Assembly during this session It is such an invaluable experience as I'm sure you know For our young Senate pages. We're delighted by the work that she and her colleagues are doing and

[01:49:29] And Senators, I ask that we give a warm welcome of the Senate to Rachel Nestor and to Craig Gill. Is there any other business to come before the Senate?

[01:49:48] The Clerk will report any announcements on the desk. Today, Wednesday, February 4, 2026, the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet 15 minutes after adjournment. This is a change in time. Courts 15 minutes after adjournment in Senate Room A, GAB.

[01:50:08] The Committee on General Laws and Technology will meet 30 minutes after adjournment. Senate Room B, General Assembly Building. The General Laws and Technology Subcommittee on Housing will not meet. Tomorrow, Thursday, February 5th, the Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Health and Human Resources will meet at 7:30 a.m. in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th Floor, GAB.

[01:50:36] The Hampton Roads Caucus will meet at 7:30 a.m. in House Room 700 A, 7th Floor, GAB. The Committee on Education and Health will meet at 8:30 a.m. Senate Room A, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11:15 a.m. in Senate Room 1 of the Capitol.

[01:50:57] The Republican Caucus will meet at 11:30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. And there are 10 days until February 14th. chair recognizes the senior senator from Virginia Beach thank you madam president I rise for an announcement senator has the floor president I wanted to remind people that tomorrow morning at 8 a.m. in room 600 B is the aviation caucus so if you're interested in aviation or space it's a good one to

[01:51:32] attend again tomorrow morning 8 a.m. 600 B thank you thank you senator the chair recognizes the senator from Colonial Heights thank you madam President, arise for an announcement. Senator has the floor. Madam President, members of the Senate, we had a very good first basketball practice last night.

[01:51:49] It was myself, the senator from Roanoke, and a staffer for Senator Aird for the Senate. The House had a lot of people there, as they tend to do, and so we really, I hope, we will have a better turnout from the Senate side next Tuesday at MLK Middle School it's just up the road in Churchill 7 o'clock to about 9 o'clock it's a it's a good time good exercise we really got to start getting together as a team and again I will make a repeated request we have got to have a

[01:52:28] point guard somebody who can handle the ball and that person is I don't think currently in this room so we need to get somebody outside this room to to step up all right thank you thank you senator is there any other business to come before the body the chair recognizes the senator from portsmouth thank you madam president madam president i move that the senate do now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow the question is shall the senate now adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow all in favor of the motion we'll say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the motion

[01:53:07] is agreed to the senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow the senate of virginia richmond

[01:53:59] Virginia. Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past

[01:56:06] meetings, and explore our full archives anytime on the Senate of Virginia's

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